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Bitcoin to $1,000,000

The Complete Breakdown: Market Cap Math + Cycle Data. Two Frameworks. One Answer.

Not vibes. Not narratives. History.

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WHAT'S INSIDE

Your $1M Bitcoin Roadmap

On March 10, 2026, Bitwise Asset Management — a $15 billion asset manager — published a memo titled 'How Bitcoin Gets to $1 Million.' Their CIO used market cap math to arrive at a clean, defensible number. The analysis is correct. But it leaves out the one framework that has never been wrong in 15 years: the halving cycle.

This guide runs both frameworks side by side. Where they agree, the conviction goes up. Where they differ, we explain why. By the end you will know exactly what $1M Bitcoin requires, when the cycle says it arrives, and what it costs to get there.

SECTION 01

The Bitwise Case: Market Cap Math

Bitwise CIO Matt Hougan argues that most people make a fundamental error when evaluating Bitcoin's long-term price potential: they use a static denominator. They look at today's market size and ask what share Bitcoin would need to hit $1M. The problem is the market itself is not static.

The correct framework, Hougan argues, is to project how the global store-of-value market will grow and estimate Bitcoin's share of that larger future market.

$38T	$121T	17%
Store-of-value market today	Projected in 10 years	BTC share needed for $1M

How the math works:

The global store-of-value market today sits at just under $38 trillion, consisting largely of gold (~$36T) and Bitcoin (~$1.4T). Bitcoin currently represents roughly 4% of that market.

If the store-of-value market continues expanding at its historical pace, Hougan estimates it reaches $121 trillion within a decade. Under that scenario, Bitcoin needs to capture approximately 17% of the market to reach $1,000,000 per coin.

> **The Key Insight**
>
> Bitcoin doesn't need to replace gold. It doesn't need to become a global currency. It just needs to keep doing what it has already been doing: capturing a growing share of a growing market. 17% is the number. That's it.

Why this framework is powerful:

The Bitwise analysis strips away all the noise — the macro narratives, the ETF flows, the regulatory headlines — and reduces $1M Bitcoin to a simple, falsifiable claim: does the store-of-value market grow, and does Bitcoin continue gaining share? Both of those things have happened every single year since 2013.

What the framework does not provide is a timeline. It tells you what price requires. It does not tell you when the clock says it arrives. That requires a different dataset entirely.

SECTION 02

The Cycle Framework: Bitcoin Runs on Time

The halving is written into the Bitcoin protocol. Every 210,000 blocks — approximately every four years — the block reward is cut in half. This is not a prediction. It is a mathematical certainty. Time is the input. Price is the output.

Three complete cycles have now played out. In each one, Bitcoin peaked approximately 518 to 550 days after the halving. Not 400 days. Not 700 days. 518 to 550. The precision is not coincidental — it is structural.

Halving Date	Peak Date	Days to Peak	Cycle ATH
Nov 2012	Nov 2013	365 days	$1,163
Jul 2016	Dec 2017	518 days	$19,891
May 2020	Nov 2021	550 days	$69,000
Apr 2024	Oct 2025	~548 days	$126,000

The 2013 cycle is an outlier given Bitcoin's extreme early-stage growth. The three most recent cycles — 2017, 2021, 2025 — have peaked within a 32-day window of each other relative to the halving. That consistency across three separate market environments, three separate macro backdrops, and three separate institutional adoption phases is not noise. It is signal.

The Core Thesis

Bitcoin does not run on price-based indicators. Pi Cycle, MVRV, Rainbow Chart — these all failed in the 2025 cycle because they measure price. The halving measures time. Time has not failed. It has not come close to failing.

This is the framework that makes the $1M timeline calculable. Not guessable. Not vibes. Calculable. Apply the halving schedule forward: April 2028 is the next halving. Add 518 to 550 days. The 2029 peak window opens in August and closes in October 2029. The same math applies to 2032 and 2036.

SECTION 03

The Multiplier Data: Declining, Not Broken

Every cycle delivers a smaller return than the one before it. This is not a bearish observation — it is the natural consequence of a maturing asset class with a growing market cap base. The multiplier shrinks because the denominator grows. The direction does not change.

Cycle	Previous ATH	New ATH	Peak-over-Peak Multiplier
2017	$1,163	$19,891	17.1x
2021	$19,891	$69,000	3.45x
2025	$69,000	$126,000	1.83x
2029 (proj.)	$126,000	$200K-$300K	~1.6-2.4x

The declining multiplier pattern is consistent and directional. Each cycle compresses returns as institutional capital, ETF flows, and corporate treasury allocations smooth out the extreme volatility that produced 17x and 3.45x cycles. This is not Bitcoin breaking. This is Bitcoin maturing.

The critical observation: even with compressed multipliers, each peak is still meaningfully higher than the last. A 1.6x multiplier from $126K still produces a $200K+ top. A 1.8x produces $227K. The compounding effect across three more cycles is what makes $1M possible — not a single explosive move.

What This Means for Your Strategy

The era of 10x cycle returns is over. The era of consistent, compounding, multi-cycle wealth building is here. The traders who understand this will position across cycles. The ones who don't will keep waiting for the '2017 move' that isn't coming.

SECTION 04

The Schedule: 2029, 2033, 2037

Apply the declining multiplier data to the halving schedule and the roadmap to $1M becomes concrete. These are not price targets pulled from sentiment. They are outputs of the same model that called the 2025 ATH window.

Halving	Peak Window	Projected ATH Range	Bear Bottom (Est.)
Apr 2024	Aug-Oct 2025	$126,000 (actual)	$38K-$50K
Apr 2028	Aug-Oct 2029	$200,000-$300,000	$80K-$120K
Apr 2032	Aug-Oct 2033	$400,000-$600,000	$160K-$240K
Apr 2036	Aug-Oct 2037	$800,000-$1,200,000	$320K-$500K

Two things are worth noting about this schedule. First, the 2037 projected ATH range of $800K-$1.2M aligns with the Bitwise market cap analysis arriving at $1M in approximately 10 years from today. Two completely different methodologies. Same destination. Same timeline. That convergence is not coincidence.

Second, the bear market bottoms are themselves significant. The estimated 2026 bottom of $38K-$50K becomes the 2029 launching pad. The 2030 bottom of $80K-$120K becomes the 2033 launching pad. Each floor is higher than the previous cycle's peak. This is the pattern that has held across every cycle.

The Compounding Floor

By 2033, the bear market bottom is projected to be higher than Bitcoin's all-time high from 2025. Think about what that means for people who accumulate during the 2026 bear market at $38K-$50K.

SECTION 05

The Three Bear Markets Between Here and $1M

This is the section nobody includes in their $1M Bitcoin thesis. The path to $1M is not a straight line. It runs directly through three more bear markets, each one averaging 60-70% drawdowns from peak to trough.

Bear Market	Est. Peak	Est. Bottom	Drawdown	Duration (Est.)
2025-2026	$126,000	$38K-$50K	-60% to -70%	~12 months
2029-2030	$200K-$300K	$80K-$120K	-55% to -65%	~12 months
2033-2034	$400K-$600K	$160K-$240K	-50% to -60%	~12 months

The drawdown pattern shows compression over time — each bear market is slightly less severe than the previous one as institutional participation and market depth increase. But 50-60% drawdowns are still violent by any traditional asset class standard.

The 2030 bear market will see Bitcoin drop from a potential $280K all-time high to somewhere around $100K. In dollar terms, that is a $180K drop. Percentage-wise it will look similar to what we are experiencing right now. Every headline will say the cycle is broken. Every influencer will have an explanation for why this time is different.

The Psychological Challenge

The hardest part of the $1M journey is not finding the right entry. It is holding through a $180K nominal drawdown in 2030 while understanding it is structurally identical to holding through a $75K drawdown in 2026. The framework does not change. The emotional difficulty scales with portfolio size.

What separates the holders from the sellers:

Historical data shows that the majority of retail participants exit during bear markets and re-enter near cycle tops. This pattern has repeated in every single cycle. The people who collect $1M Bitcoin are not the ones with the strongest conviction today. They are the ones with a framework robust enough to survive three separate moments where every signal says sell.

SECTION 06

Two Frameworks. One Answer.

This is the most important section in the guide. When two completely independent analytical frameworks — one built on market structure, one built on protocol mechanics — arrive at the same price target in the same timeframe, that is not a coincidence. That is confirmation.

	Bitwise (Market Cap)	@bitcoin.daily (Cycle)
Methodology	TAM x Market Share	Halving + Multiplier Model
Data Source	Store-of-value market	15 years of cycle data
$1M Timeline	~10 years	2037 cycle top
Key Assumption	BTC captures 17% of $121T	Declining multipliers hold
Track Record	Institutional analysis	In crypto since 2016. Called 2022 bottom + 2025 ATH years early
Agreement	YES	YES

The Bitwise framework answers 'what does $1M require?' The cycle framework answers 'when does the protocol say $1M arrives?' Neither framework alone is sufficient. Together they form the most complete publicly available analysis of Bitcoin's path to $1M.

The cycle framework used here is not new. It has been the basis of market analysis at @bitcoin.daily since 2016 — nearly a decade of data science applied to Bitcoin's halving cycles. That work produced two publicly documented calls: the 2022 bear market bottom, and the 2025 cycle top — both called years before they happened. The $1M timeline is the same model, extended forward.

The critical caveat: the cycle framework has a 15-year sample size across 3-4 complete cycles. That is statistically meaningful but not infallible. Black swan events — quantum computing threats, regulatory bans in major economies, fundamental protocol failures — could break the model. The probability of any of those events is low. It is not zero. Size positions accordingly.

The Bottom Line

Bitcoin to $1M is not a bold prediction. It is the base case output of two independent analytical frameworks that have both proven directionally correct over multiple years. The only question worth asking is not IF. It is whether you will still be holding when the clock reaches 2037.

SECTION 07

Actionable Insights: What to Do Right Now

Understanding the framework is step one. Knowing what to do with it is step two. Here are five concrete actions based on where we are in the current cycle.

01 Treat the 2026 bear market as a structured accumulation window

The current bear market is projected to bottom between $38K-$50K in approximately October 2026. That is not a prediction to panic about. It is a calendar event to prepare for. Dollar-cost averaging into weakness with a defined position size is the professional approach. Trying to catch the exact bottom is not.

02 Define your exit framework before the 2029 bull run starts

The 2029 cycle top is projected in the August-October 2029 window. That gives you approximately 3 years to build your exit strategy before you need it. Write it down now. Price targets, time-based triggers, position sizing on the way out. Decisions made during euphoria are almost always wrong.

03 Size for survival across three cycles, not maximum gain in one

If your position sizing requires a 3x in the next cycle to achieve your goal, you are over-allocated. The multi-cycle path to $1M rewards consistent, survivable position sizes over concentrated bets. Volatility kills portfolios that cannot absorb 60% drawdowns without forced selling.

04 Stop monitoring price-based indicators

MVRV, Pi Cycle, Rainbow Chart, Puell Multiple — all of these failed in the 2025 cycle. They are price-based tools trying to time a time-based asset. The only indicator with a perfect track record across all modern cycles is the halving clock. Watch the calendar, not the chart.

05 Understand the floor appreciation thesis

By the 2033 cycle, the bear market bottom is projected to be higher than the 2025 all-time high of $126K. Every satoshi accumulated during the 2026 bear market at $40K-$70K will be worth more than $126K before Bitcoin ever reaches $1M. The accumulation phase is not the painful part of the journey. It is the most valuable part.

Two frameworks.

One answer.

One clock.

The data has spoken. The cycle has never missed. The market cap math agrees. $1,000,000 per Bitcoin is not optimism. It is arithmetic.

Want the full trading framework for navigating all 3 cycles?

Join the Discord community for live trade alerts, weekly cycle updates, and the tools to trade every phase between now and $1M.

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